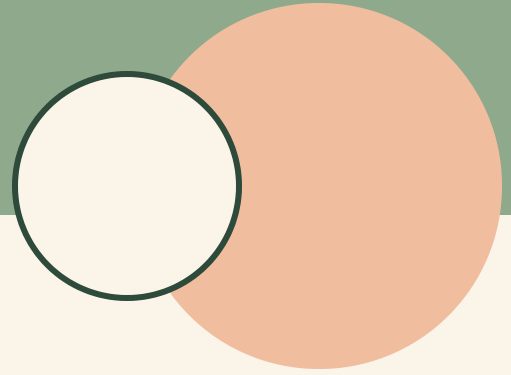




A GIFT FOR HUMAN NOTE READERS

Carry It Together

*A permission note and six ways to ask for help, for
anyone who learned to carry everything alone.*

Inside: one permission note to sign · six sentences you can borrow · four
questions for a quiet minute

You don't have to carry all the bags.

If you are the one everybody leans on, this page is for you.

Somewhere along the way you learned that being strong meant never needing anything. Maybe life handed you too much, too early. You got very good at it. I did too.

Years later, my mother-in-law, Ma Estelle, sat down with me and said this:

"If you buy groceries, instead of carrying all the bags yourself, maybe give a few of the heavy ones to Jurie, and you can carry the weight of it together rather than all alone."

MA ESTELLE

Nobody had ever given me permission to not carry it alone. So I'm passing it on to you.

- You are allowed to hand someone a heavy bag.
- You are allowed to need things, and to say so out loud.
- You are allowed to be a regular person, not the hero.
- You are allowed to let the people who love you show up.

I don't have to earn my place by being invincible. This week, I give myself permission to put one thing down.

SIGNED

DATE

Six sentences you can borrow

Knowing you're allowed to ask is one thing. Finding the words is another. Start with whichever one feels least scary.

1

The small, specific ask

"Could you take this one off my plate today?"

Name one task, not the whole load. Small asks are easier to say and easier to say yes to.

2

When they offer and your reflex is "I'm fine"

"Actually, yes. That would help."

Four words. Catch the automatic no and swap it once this week.

3

When you need company, not a fix

"I don't need you to solve this. I just need you with me for a minute."

Telling people what kind of help you want makes it far easier for them to give it.

4

Naming the pattern to your person

"I learned to do everything myself a long time ago. I'm trying to unlearn it. Be patient with me when I push your help away."

This lets them in on what's really happening, so your no stops feeling like a wall.

5

Sharing the weight at home

"I've been carrying this one alone. Can we split it?"

Good for the invisible jobs: the planning, the remembering, the deciding.

6

When you catch yourself in hero mode

"Wait. This isn't required anymore."

This one you say to yourself. Then pick one thing to hand over or leave undone.

It will feel awkward the first few times. That's just what a new habit feels like.

Four questions, no right answers

Write a line or two. Nobody is marking this.

1. What am I carrying right now that I haven't told anyone is heavy?

2. When did I first learn that I had to be the strong one?

3. Who would gladly take a bag if I let them?

4. One bag I will hand over this week, and which sentence I'll use:

The bags are lighter when you're carrying them together.